Ohio Equal Parenting and Parent-Child Relationship Protection Act

Revision 5 — Final working draft (4 October 2026)

For review by outside Ohio family-law counsel and the Legislative Service Commission. Ohio and federal law are stated as of 4 October 2026. Earlier revisions are in `archive-rev1/` to `archive-rev4/`; primary sources are in `sources/`.

The bill in four sentences: 1. Two fit parents should start equal. 2. Money designated for a child should benefit the child. 3. A court order stays the order until the parents agree otherwise or a court changes it. 4. A court order must have a practical enforcement mechanism.

#	Document
1	`01-Research-Memorandum.md` (§ 23 is new in Revision 5)
2	`02-Design-Memo.md`
3	`03-Section-by-Section-Outline.md`
4	`04-Plain-English-Summary.md`
5	`05-Proposed-Statutory-Language.md` (**the bill**, in Ohio bill form: amends 9 sections, enacts 5; full text of amended sections)
6	`06-Redline-Crosswalk.md`
7	`07-Constitutional-Stress-Test.md`
8	`08-Cut-List.md` (Revision 4 → 5)
9	`09-Court-Workload-Memo.md` (workload and fiscal)
10	`10-Final-Decisions-and-Technical-Questions.md` (no open policy questions)
11	`11-Sponsor-Brief.md` (two-page handout)

Roles: courts decide genuine disputes; the county child support agency, also designated the Family Support Enforcement Agency (FSEA), handles routine enforcement; GALs investigate and recommend; prosecutors decide charges; parents parent.

Word and PDF copies. Word files are in `docx/` and PDFs in `pdf/`. Rebuild them after any edit with `./make-docx.sh` (Word only) or `./make-docx.sh --pdf` (Word and PDF). Templates and filters are in `templates/`; the Markdown files are the masters and are never modified by the build.